

INDIAN SECURITY AND SURVEILLANCE MARKET

Despite the huge demand and the various applications of security products, India is still not a commanding player in the security segment. The picture on the manufacturing front doesn't seem positive either. The government has to come forward with a specific policy to attract investments in this sector with a comprehensive package of incentives



IP based video door phone system from Honeywell Security Group

■ RICHA CHAKRAVARTY

From physical security personnel to the era of biometrics, who would have ever thought that virtual eyeballs (lens) would one day keep a check on our daily activities. Replacing traditional security measures, technology today has smoothly swept into our personal domain, keeping a check on our movements, restraining our access and verifying the authenticity of our identity. Growing terrorist activities, increasing crime rates and intrusion on protected information has

led to the growth of the security and surveillance industry across the globe.

Security and surveillance is a vast segment that can be broadly divided into three categories—video surveillance or closed circuit cameras (CCTVs), access control systems (ACS) and identification devices (use of biometrics). According to an IMS research report, the Indian network video equipment market alone was valued at \$38.1 million in 2010 and is poised to grow to \$127.7 million by 2014. This fast growth is due to the demand from various sectors such

as urban or city security, educational campuses, public transport, hospitality, harbours and airports, entertainment outlets, etc.

Currently, the government is the biggest spender on physical security or surveillance solutions. In this regard, use of CCTVs or video surveillance, in particular, has emerged as the most viable solution and has gained significant momentum in the country. This is followed by access control devices, and the latest upsurge in the security domain has been in biometrics-based security solutions.

Enormous demand

A Frost & Sullivan report shows that the video surveillance segment is growing at a CAGR of 25 to 30 per cent and the sector is pegged at 8.66 billion. Two years ago, the US and Europe accounted for 86 per cent of the security camera market. Today, the Asia-Pacific region is also catching up and India registered a double digit growth rate. By extending its application to airports, railways, metro stations, malls, corporate houses, hotels, liquor shops and residences, security cameras have become an integral part of vigilance today. "Following the November 2008 attacks in Mumbai, government, business houses and individuals are investing significant amounts in installing and upgrading their security infrastructure. This heightened aware-